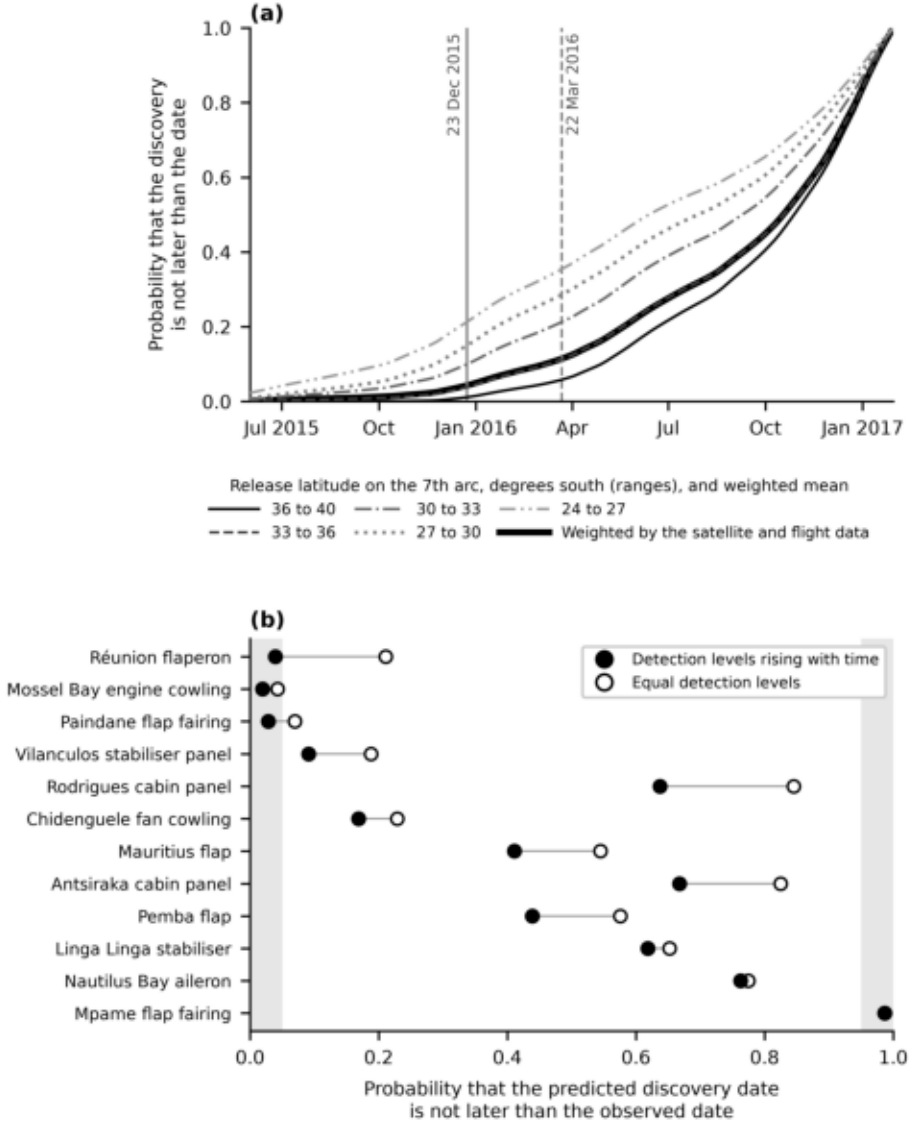

(a) Predicted date of discovery of the Mossel Bay engine cowling, as a cumulative probability, for debris released from five ranges of latitude on the 7th arc (drift model, two ocean models with equal weight, equal detection level at all times). Heavy line: release latitudes weighted by the satellite communication and flight data. Vertical lines: 23 December 2015, the date of the photograph supplied to the Australian Transport Safety Bureau; 22 March 2016, the date given for the find. (b) For each find, the probability that the predicted date of discovery is not later than the observed date, with the satellite communication and flight data as weights for the release latitude. Filled circles: detection levels that rise with time (provisional); open circles: equal detection levels. Shaded: below 0.05 and above 0.95. A value near 0 means that the find is earlier than the model predicts; the cowling gives 0.02 and 0.04. For finds near the end of the window (30 January 2017) the value is pushed towards 1.